

Chapter 26_2 - Jealousy

After about half an incense stick's time, a completely new array formation appeared on the paper. She put down her brush and quietly recited an incantation, then extended her fingertip as immortal power suddenly surged forth.

The ink marks on the paper suddenly transformed into dense black energy, then in the next instant burst into brilliant golden light, slowly floating in mid-air and expanding to the width of a person. The golden light was dazzlingly bright, making Ning Fuyi quickly close her eyes to prevent injury.

Something seemed to be drawing her consciousness, and suddenly a mountain appeared in her sea of consciousness. That mountain was half-floating in a sea of clouds. Looking closer, the mountain had pavilions and towers with immortal mist swirling around, and countless rare birds with colorful tail feathers dancing and singing in mid-air.

A strange feeling compelled her to lean forward slightly, as if something was calling to her, making her urgently want to step into the mountain.

Ning Fuyi suddenly opened her eyes. The array's radiance vanished without a trace. She breathed heavily, her mind filled with barely suppressible excitement.

Zhaoyao Mountain!

What was in her sea of consciousness was undoubtedly Zhaoyao Mountain!

Ning Fuyi staggered as she sat down, tucking the fallen strands of hair behind her ears, her phoenix eyes revealing a dangerous gleam.

Zhaoyao Mountain was a pure land filled with supreme treasures, guarded by four divine beasts called Qingluan¹. Ordinary people could not ascend it, so it seemed that tomorrow's selection was something she absolutely had to attend.

No matter what methods she used, she had to secure a spot.

As she was pondering, footsteps suddenly came from outside. Ning Fuyi quickly resumed her usual appearance, calmly threw the paper with the array formation into the waste basket, and lit it with a fire starter, burning it to ash.

She had just finished cleaning up when the door was knocked. Ning Fuyi got up and walked to the main hall, opening the door.

"Du... Man'er?" She looked at that face as pure as a white flower after rain outside the door and exclaimed in surprise.

"Greetings to Elder Sister Immortal." The young girl was holding something in her arms and spoke in a delicate voice.

Ning Fuyi never expected the young girl would come here looking for her. She looked at her carefully for a few moments and stepped back: "The sun has already set. What brings you here?"

"Coming to disturb Elder Sister without announcing myself first is my fault." The young girl's every word showed her clever nature. But her voice was pleasant, she was beautiful as a flower, and her body was frail - even if she laid all her thoughts bare, she couldn't earn dislike.

"Never mind, it's windy outside. Come in." Ning Fuyi relaxed her grip, turned and went back inside. The young girl silently followed and obediently closed the door.

Under the candlelight, she coughed twice, and her slender willow-like waist swayed. She coughed until her eyes were full of tears, making even Ning Fuyi feel some pity.

However, at this age, her face was still childish and didn't resemble Chu Qingqiu so much yet. Ning Fuyi inexplicably lost her previous interest in looking at her closely and turned to pour her a cup of cooled tea: "Have some tea, Man'er."

"Thank you, Elder Sister." The young girl held something in one hand and took the tea with the other, bringing it to her lips. Those lips touched with tea became crystal clear.

"Only I'm not called Man'er. I was captured not long after transforming and was transported far to Furong Town to be sold. I suffered hardships all along the way, with no one to give me a name." The young girl said, then smiled sadly.

Ning Fuyi frowned as she watched her movements, not responding for a long while.

But the young girl seemed not to mind at all and continued talking: "Elder Sister protected me - you're the first good person I've met in this world. Could I ask Elder Sister to grant me a name and surname, so I won't be a nameless little grass anymore?"

Though Ning Fuyi didn't like her at all, this girl had died by her own hand in the previous life after all, so she had more patience and said: "Among mountain orchids and azaleas, white and matchless. How about Du Baishuang?"

"Du Baishuang." The young girl's bright eyes curved as if she suddenly became happy. "I like it. Thank you, Elder Sister."

As the two were talking, neither noticed there was already another person outside the door. The evening wind blew strongly, and a tall white figure stood outside, her clothes like butterfly wings, fluttering lonely.

The little white tiger circled around her feet twice, trying to push the door, but was stopped by Chu Qingqiu's gaze.

She shook her head, looking through the wooden door into the warm interior with complex emotions.

The young girl held what was in her hands and pushed it toward Ning Fuyi's hands, smiling gently: "Elder Sister, this is what I made for you. Unfold it and take a look."

Ning Fuyi originally wanted to dodge, but the young girl seemed to trip and suddenly leaned softly into her embrace. Ning Fuyi immediately became flustered. She managed to avoid the person but not the object, and when she stood steady to one side, her hands already held a stack of fabric light as air.

"What is this?" Ning Fuyi asked puzzled.

"These are clothes I made for Elder Sister, as a token of gratitude for saving me from fire and water." Du Baishuang shyly lowered her eyes. "This is made from fabric transformed from my own grass leaves - light as flying feathers, waterproof and fireproof, tough and indestructible."

"Please don't disdain it, Elder Sister. Look, I even embroidered a little grass on the collar..." Du Baishuang said as she leaned forward, her forehead hair inadvertently brushing past Ning Fuyi's nose tip.

From a distance, their two shadows merged into one. Chu Qingqiu immediately looked away and turned around with her hands behind her back.

The little white tiger whimpered and used its paws to indicate she should knock on the door.

"They have a guest - what's the point of knocking?" Chu Qingqiu said coldly. The sky was half-dark, and there wasn't a trace of light in her eyes, so dim that her expression couldn't be seen clearly.

"Since there are already clothes, there's no need for me to meddle further." Chu Qingqiu looked at the folded, wrinkled fabric in her hands, her pearl-white teeth grazing her lips as she raised her hand and threw it into the grass.

The fresh wounds on her hands that hadn't had time to heal were exposed to the air for an instant, then hidden back in her sleeves.

"Come, Bai Lin." She said quietly, then stepped forward into the gradually darkening night.

Author's Notes:

I couldn't think of any flirty lines today T-T

Crowdsourcing one line³

Footnotes:

1. **Qingluan (青鸾)** - Mythical blue phoenixes that serve as divine guardians
 2. **Du Baishuang (杜白双)** - The name means "azalea white frost," playing on the girl's pure appearance and tragic fate
 3. **Author's note** - The author is asking readers to contribute romantic or flirty dialogue suggestions in the comments
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Author's Notes: This chapter shows Chu Qingqiu's growing jealousy as she witnesses what appears to be an intimate moment between Ning Fuyi and Du Baishuang. The discovery of Zhaoyao Mountain through Ning Fuyi's array experimentation sets up important plot developments, while the romantic tension builds through Chu Qingqiu's hidden feelings and her discarded attempt to make clothes for Ning Fuyi.